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Introduction

Prepare for the exam with practice tests from Cambridge

Inside you'll find four authentic examination papers from Cambridge Assessment English. They are the perfect way to practise – EXACTLY like the real exam.

Why are they unique?

All our authentic practice tests go through the same design process as the *B2 First* exam. We check every single part of our practice tests with real students under exam conditions, to make sure we give you the most authentic experience possible.

Students can practise these tests on their own or with the help of a teacher to familiarise themselves with the exam format, understand the scoring system and practise exam technique.

Cambridge English Qualifications	CEFR Level	UK National Qualifications
C2 Proficiency	C2	3
C1 Advanced	C1	2
B2 First	B2	1
B1 Preliminary	B1	Entry 3
A2 Key	A2	Entry 2

Further information

The information contained in this practice book is designed to be an overview of the exam. For a full description of all of the above exams, including information about task types, testing focus and preparation, please see the relevant handbooks which can be obtained from the Cambridge Assessment English website at: cambridgeenglish.org.

The structure of *B2 First*: an overview

The *Cambridge English Qualifications B2 First* examination consists of four papers:

Reading and Use of English: 1 hour 15 minutes

In Parts 1 to 4, the test contains texts with accompanying grammar and vocabulary tasks, and separate items with a grammar and vocabulary focus. In Parts 5 to 7, the test contains a range of texts and accompanying reading comprehension tasks.

Writing: 1 hour 20 minutes

In Part 1, which is **compulsory**, candidates have to write an essay of between 140 and 190 words, giving their opinion in response to a task. In Part 2, there are three tasks from which candidates choose **one** to write about. The range of tasks from which questions may be drawn includes an article, an email or letter, a report and a review. In this part, candidates have to write between 140 and 190 words.

Listening: 40 minutes approximately

Each part contains a recorded text or texts and some questions, including multiple-choice, sentence completion and multiple-matching questions. Each text is heard twice.

Speaking: 14 minutes (or 20 minutes for groups of 3)

The standard test format is two candidates and two examiners. Candidates will be given photographs and other visual and written material to look at and talk about.

	Overall length	Number of tasks/parts	Number of items
Reading and Use of English	1 hour 15 minutes	7	52
Writing	1 hour 20 minutes	2	-
Listening	approx. 40 mins	4	30
Speaking	14–20 mins	4	-
Total	3 hours 30 mins approximately		

Grading

All candidates receive a Statement of Results and candidates whose performance ranges between CEFR Levels B1 and C1 (Cambridge English Scale scores of 140–190) also receive a certificate.

- Candidates who achieve **Grade A** (Cambridge English Scale scores of 180–190) receive the First Certificate in English stating that they demonstrated ability at Level C1.
- Candidates who achieve **Grade B** or **C** (Cambridge English Scale scores of 160–179) receive the First Certificate in English at Level B2.
- Candidates whose performance is below B2 level, but falls within **Level B1** (Cambridge English Scale scores of 140–159), receive a Cambridge English certificate stating that they have demonstrated ability at Level B1.
- For further information on grading and results, go to the website (see page 4 for details).

Speaking: an overview for candidates

You take the Speaking test with another candidate (possibly two candidates), referred to here as your partner. There are two examiners. One will speak to you and your partner and the other will be listening. Both examiners will award marks.

Part 1 (2 minutes)

The examiner asks you and your partner questions about yourselves. You may be asked about things like 'your home town', 'your interests', 'your career plans', etc.

Part 2 (a one-minute 'long turn' for each candidate, plus a 30-second response from the second candidate)

The examiner gives you two photographs and asks you to talk about them for one minute. The examiner then asks your partner a question about your photographs and your partner responds briefly.

Then the examiner gives your partner two different photographs. Your partner talks about these photographs for one minute. This time the examiner asks you a question about your partner's photographs and you respond briefly.

Part 3 (4 minutes)

The examiner asks you and your partner to talk together. They give you a task to look at so you can think about and discuss an idea, giving reasons for your opinion. For example, you may be asked to think about some changes in the world, or about spending free time with your family. After you have discussed the task for about two minutes with your partner, the examiner will ask you a follow-up question, which you should discuss for a further minute.

Part 4 (4 minutes)

The examiner asks some further questions, which leads to a more general discussion of what you have talked about in Part 3. You may comment on your partner's answers if you wish.

Test 1

READING AND USE OF ENGLISH (1 hour 15 minutes)

Part 1

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

Example:

0 A arrive B enter C gain D stay

0	A	B	C	D
	☐	☒	☐	☐

Seeing Australia's most famous animals

Many international visitors to Australia (0) the country through the city of Melbourne and (1) out on their tours from there. If you do so, it's extremely (2) that you will ever (3) across kangaroos or koalas in the city. You'll have to get out of town to see them. You can always book a tour that (4) wildlife watching experiences.

On the other hand, you may decide to do it on your own. In that case, head out on the Great Ocean Road from Melbourne and you'll see the Kennett River Holiday Park. You'll soon find loads of koalas in the trees. After your (5) there, drive up to the Grampians National Park. It's (6) worth taking an afternoon walk there before renting a room at the Kookaburra Lodge looking out on the stunning scenery. Kangaroos (7) in large groups at sunrise and sunset, and you'll have a front (8) seat.

- | | | | | |
|---|------------|------------|---------------|------------|
| 1 | A leave | B carry | C set | D break |
| 2 | A unknown | B unclear | C uncertain | D unlikely |
| 3 | A come | B bring | C get | D look |
| 4 | A deals | B offers | C specialises | D focuses |
| 5 | A incident | B occasion | C instance | D time |
| 6 | A just | B simply | C well | D deeply |
| 7 | A blend | B gather | C attend | D combine |
| 8 | A place | B row | C queue | D line |

Part 2

For questions **9–16**, read the text below and think of the word which best fits each gap. Use only **one** word in each gap. There is an example at the beginning **(0)**.

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Example:

0	I	N															
---	---	---	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

The Oscars

Many countries have annual awards for outstanding achievements **(0)** the film industry. By **(9)** the most famous awards are those made by the American Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences – the Oscars. The name actually refers **(10)** the statuette which all of the winners receive. The awards go not only to actors but also to other people involved in the production of a film, **(11)** as make-up artists and costume designers.

Nobody knows for certain **(12)** these statuettes are called Oscars. The most widely accepted story concerns Margaret Herrick, the secretary to the Academy. **(13)** she first saw the statuettes in 1931, her initial reaction **(14)** to say that they looked remarkably **(15)** her cousin, Oscar Pierce. He worked on a farm and actually had **(16)** at all to do with the film industry.

Part 3

For questions 17–24, read the text below. Use the word given in capitals at the end of some of the lines to form a word that fits in the gap in the same line. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Example: 0 I N F L U E N T I A L

Drawing with scissors

Frenchman Henri Matisse was among the most (0) artists of the twentieth century. He produced masterpieces in a wide (17) of media including painting, sculpture and printmaking, but some consider his most (18) work to be from his later years, when he suffered from partial (19) and was confined to his bed and a wheelchair. Because of this, he used an (20) method he called 'drawing with scissors'. He cut brightly-painted sheets of paper into large shapes. Under his guidance these paper cut-outs were attached to the walls of his studio. He then directed his (21) to move the pieces into the precise (22) he had in mind.

The inspiration for some of the most remarkable scissor drawings was (23) places Matisse had previously visited but, because of his age, could no longer return to, such as two works he made in 1946 based on an (24) trip he had made to Tahiti many years before.

INFLUENCE

VARY

INNOVATE

BLIND

EXPERIMENT

ASSIST

ARRANGE

MEMORY

FORGET

Part 4

For questions **25–30**, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **two** and **five** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

- 0 A very friendly taxi driver drove us into town.

DRIVEN

We a very friendly taxi driver.

The gap can be filled by the words 'were driven into town by', so you write:

Example:

0	WERE DRIVEN INTO TOWN BY
---	--------------------------

Write **only** the missing words **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

- 25 I cannot remember a time when Dr Rowan was not the president of the club.

AS

Dr Rowan has been the president of the club for
remember.

- 26 The furthest my brother can run is 5 kilometres.

NO

My brother 5 kilometres.

- 27 I spent more money on my holiday than I meant to.

SO

I didn't money on my holiday.

- 28 My doctor said that I must only run in proper running shoes.

NEVER

My doctor told I was wearing proper running shoes.

- 29 The engineer explained clearly how the machinery worked.

CLEAR

The engineer gave a how the machinery worked.

- 30 The concert was cancelled when it began to snow.

OWING

The concert was called the snow.

Part 5

You are going to read an extract from the autobiography of the tennis player Rafael Nadal. For questions 31–36, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which you think fits best according to the text.

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Looking back at the Wimbledon tennis championships

The silence, that's what strikes you when you play on Centre Court at the Wimbledon tennis championships. You bounce the ball soundlessly up and down on the soft grass surface; you toss it up to serve; you hit it and you hear the echo of your own shot. And of every shot after that. The trimmed grass, the rich history, the ancient stadium, the players dressed in white, the respectful crowds, all combine to enclose and cushion you from the outside world. The quiet of the Centre Court is good for my game. What I battle against hardest in a tennis match is to shut everything out of my mind but the contest itself and the point I'm playing.

The silence of the Centre Court is broken by a shock of noise when a point's done: applause, cheers, people shouting your name. I hear them, but as if from some place far off. I don't register that there are fifteen thousand people hunched around the arena, tracking every move my opponent and I make. I am so focused I have no sense at all that there are millions watching me around the world as I play Roger Federer in the 2008 Wimbledon final – the biggest match of my life.

I had always dreamed of playing at Wimbledon. My uncle Toni, who has been my coach all my life, had drummed into me from an early age that this was the biggest tournament of them all. By the time I was 14, I was sharing with my friends the fantasy that I'd play there one day and win. Before 2008, though, I'd played and lost, both times against Federer – in the final there the year before, and the year before that. The defeat in 2006 had not been so hard. I went out onto the court that time just pleased and grateful that, having just turned twenty, I'd made it that far. Federer beat me pretty easily, more

easily than if I'd gone out with more belief. But my defeat in 2007 left me utterly destroyed. I knew I could have done better, that it was not my ability or the quality of my game that had failed me, but my head. Losing always hurts, but it hurts much more when you have a chance and throw it away.

Toni, the toughest of tennis coaches, is usually the last person in the world to offer me consolation; he criticizes me even when I win. It is a measure of what a wreck I must have been that he abandoned the habit of a lifetime and told me there was no reason to despair, that there would be more Wimbledons and more Wimbledon finals. I told him he didn't understand, that this had probably been my last chance to win it. Every single moment counts but some moments count for more than others, and I had let a big one pass in 2007.

There was nothing Toni could do to ease my grief. Yet here I was again in 2008, just one year later. I was confident I'd learnt the lesson from that defeat twelve months earlier; that whatever else gave way this time, my head would not. The best sign that my head was in the right place now was the conviction that I would win.

At dinner with family and friends and team members the night before the final, at the house we always rent when I play at Wimbledon, mention of the match had been off-limits. I didn't expressly forbid them from raising the subject, but they all understood well enough that, whatever else I might have been talking about, I was already beginning to play the match in a space inside my head. From here on in until the start of play, that space should remain mine alone.

- 31 The writer says that the silence at Wimbledon Centre Court
- A calms his nerves during matches.
 - B gives him confidence in his abilities.
 - C helps him to concentrate on the game.
 - D makes him feel that he's respected.
- 32 In the second paragraph, what does the writer suggest about the 2008 match?
- A It was all that concerned him at that time.
 - B His opponent was distracted by the behaviour of the crowd.
 - C It proved how popular he had become.
 - D His fans seemed almost as anxious as he was.
- 33 What does the writer say about playing Federer in two Wimbledon finals?
- A Nerves let him down in the first match.
 - B He had different attitudes to the two matches.
 - C He was too ambitious when he played the first match.
 - D The quality of his game improved in the second match.
- 34 The writer says that after he lost in the 2007 final, his coach
- A encouraged him to think about how much he'd already achieved.
 - B was unusually sympathetic towards him.
 - C failed to recognise his disappointment.
 - D criticised his performance unfairly.
- 35 What does 'gave way' mean in line 65?
- A developed unexpectedly
 - B became stronger
 - C kept going through difficulties
 - D failed to function
- line 36 What does the writer say about his family and friends?
- A They take his mind off tennis.
 - B They respect his need for privacy.
 - C They help him in any way they can.
 - D They see things from a different perspective.

Part 6

You are going to read a magazine article about video games. Six sentences have been removed from the article. Choose from the sentences **A–G** the one which fits each gap (37–42). There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

In praise of video games

Why do serious media commentators largely ignore the biggest entertainment medium in the world? Author Naomi Alderman investigates.

Why do video games receive so little coverage in the mainstream media? It's a question that's troubled me for years – I even made a programme about it for the radio. Games are the largest entertainment medium in the world, yet newspaper culture pages tend not to cover them. Cultural programmes on TV and radio might do a short feature about them once in a while at best, reserving serious discussion and analysis for specialist things with a very limited audience like interpretive dance and experimental opera.

My novels, which sell tens of thousands of copies, are shortlisted for prizes that appear on the news. My games, which have sold millions of copies, don't even make the news. Film and TV awards ceremonies are a news story. **37** I think all this is a shame because it affects the way people think about the medium. It means we don't get the kind of analysis that mainstream media can produce, and we're prevented from asking interesting questions about games in our culture.

There are several reasons for this exclusion. People who control programming and edit papers tend to be in their 50s and older, and are still a bit old to have come of age with video games or to understand them. And games, because they're very much products of a collaborative effort, normally don't have a single creator or celebrity to represent them in interviews. **38**

But I want to suggest another reason why games aren't treated as an important cultural form.

39 At least, that is the impression I get. They make it amazingly hard to get hold of new games, even for someone who writes about them.

I write about novels as well as games and barely a day passes when a publisher isn't posting me a copy of a new book in the hope I'll review it or mention it somewhere. **40** If the games industry wanted to be treated like other cultural media, it could start by making its work accessible to mainstream journalists.

There's a timing issue too. In the past, I've tried to persuade review programmes to cover games more frequently. But I always seem to come up against the same old problem. Film companies organise pre-release screenings, TV companies send out early versions of their shows, publishers send copies of new books, theatres do previews – but games companies won't send out advance versions of games. **41**

Furthermore, the games industry itself does not seem too bothered about being covered in broadsheet culture sections, because it doesn't think this would sell more games. It is already the biggest selling entertainment industry in the world in any case. **42** It's a fair point, but I wish the industry would cooperate anyway because games are important and deserve to be regarded as such in the mainstream media.

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>A With books you have authors; with films you have directors; so the situation is very different.</p> <p>B However, gamers are still being viewed as socially inadequate teenagers.</p> <p>C So what difference would, for example, a weekly games programme on TV make to it?</p> <p>D Those for games are only for industry specialists.</p> | <p>E This is that the people in the games industry itself don't care enough.</p> <p>F That's because they usually need to make technical changes right up until the last minute.</p> <p>G By contrast, I spend hours doing phone-rounds in the hope of getting hold of a copy of a game.</p> |
|---|---|

Part 7

You are going to read an article written by an architect about his work. For questions **43–52**, choose from the sections **(A–D)**. The sections may be chosen more than once.

Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

In which section does the architect mention

employees being trusted to organise themselves in the way they think is best?	43	
how problems among employees are resolved?	44	
the range of people needed for some architectural projects?	45	
being told that he would have fewer responsibilities in a new position?	46	
the limited control higher-ranking people have over what employees do?	47	
seeking help from colleagues?	48	
having mixed feelings about his work?	49	
a requirement for the performance of all employees to be exceptional?	50	
the value of employees to his business?	51	
having to demonstrate independence straightaway in a new post?	52	

Being an architect

- A** After I graduated, I took the first job I was offered. I felt torn at the time because although I was really happy to have found a job right out of school when so many others could not, I hated retail design at architectural school and this was a firm specialising in retail stores. It was a small company (I was the first employee hired) and because it did work around the country, my boss travelled quite a bit. Almost from day one, I was left on my own for several days a week and, through necessity, I was taking meetings with local clients and giving presentations without help. It wasn't too much later that I started helping with the billing and managing some of the proposal writing duties. I got to do it all. When I left the job, I remember going into an interview with a larger firm and telling them that I had all this experience. The person interviewing me chuckled and said, 'You won't be doing that here straightaway – that's what the senior employees do.'
- B** I now run my own small company. Because we're not so big, we really need everyone in the office to be superstars. It can be a difficult environment for some types of people to work in because we expect everyone to work on their own initiative. We need our employees to make the most of the resources available to them, including asking questions of others on their team, looking at past projects and using the lessons learned to find possible ways forward. We give our staff plenty of time and space to do their own thing. They need to be clever enough to arrange and make use of this time and space wisely.
- C** Everybody in our office is part of a team. Normally, we have two or three people working on a project, and everybody has access to the same people and information. Individuals tend to roll on and off projects as and when needed. There is always a senior level person who remains on a project throughout the entire process and is the point of contact, but we like to let people find their own roles on projects and pursue the things that interest them. We all get along pretty well and any issues with behaviour get dealt with as they arise between the individuals concerned. The people who work for me really are the company's most important asset. Sure, we could replace them with others, but it would be very hard to find the right balance of skills that we currently have.
- D** I often get asked if architecture is a field for everyone. It's a difficult question to answer. What I look for in potential new employees is their ability to speak articulately. This is essential. Since we require all employees to meet with clients, they need to be able to construct a narrative that can engage our clients and which they can relate to. I look for the same characteristics in all employees, regardless of gender, nationality, age, whatever. I think it takes a certain type of brain to practise architecture but that doesn't necessarily mean that everyone can't find a place. While most people don't go into architectural school thinking that they are going to be anything other than the world's next great designer, the truth of the matter is that it takes a small army of people from diverse backgrounds to take on some of the buildings being constructed these days.

WRITING (1 hour 20 minutes)

Part 1

You **must** answer this question. Write your answer in **140–190** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1 In your English class you have been talking about helping other people. Now, your English teacher has asked you to write an essay.

Write your essay using **all** the notes and giving reasons for your point of view.

'Everyone should do something regularly in their life to help other people.' Do you agree?

Notes

Write about:

1. the importance of friends and family
2. giving something back to society
3. (your own idea)

Part 2

Write an answer to **one** of the questions **2–4** in this part. Write your answer in **140–190** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet. Put the question number in the box at the top of the answer sheet.

- 2 Your English teacher has asked you to write a report on the cycling facilities in your area for the college magazine.

In your report, you should:

- explain what facilities are available for cyclists
- describe popular places for cyclists to visit
- recommend ways in which cycling can be made safer in your area.

Write your **report**.

- 3 You have seen this announcement in an English-language magazine.

Articles wanted

A sense of humour

What does having a good sense of humour mean? How important is it to see the funny side of life? Are there any disadvantages to laughing a lot?

The best articles will be published in our magazine.

Write your **article**.

- 4 You receive this email from your English friend, Hannah.

Subject: Summer job

I want to get a job in the summer. My uncle works for a publishing company and says I could work there. It'd be really interesting but they can't afford to pay me much. Or I could work in the local supermarket. The pay would be better but it'd be really boring. What should I do?

Write your **email**.

Test 1 answer key

Reading and Use of English

Part 1

1 C 2 D 3 A 4 B 5 D 6 C 7 B 8 B



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource bank

Part 2

9 far 10 to 11 such 12 why 13 When 14 was
15 like 16 nothing

Part 3

17 variety 18 innovative/innovatory 19 blindness 20 experimental
21 assistant(s) 22 arrangement(s) 23 memorable 24 unforgettable

Part 4

25 AS long as | I (can)
26 can run NO | further/farther/more than
27 mean/intend to spend | SO much
28 me NEVER to | run unless
29 CLEAR explanation | of
30 off | OWING to

Part 5

31 C 32 A 33 B 34 B 35 D 36 B

Part 6

37 D 38 A 39 E 40 G 41 F 42 C

Part 7

43 B 44 C 45 D 46 A 47 C 48 B 49 A 50 B 51 C 52 A

Listening

Part 1

1 A 2 B 3 A 4 A 5 C 6 B 7 A 8 C



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource bank

Part 2

9 International Conservation 10 donkey 11 Medicine
Garden 12 storms 13 bicycle/bike 14 growth
15 shelters 16 (the) (ancient/old) villages 17 terrace
18 sun(-)cream

Part 3

19 E 20 F 21 B 22 H 23 D

Part 4

24 B 25 C 26 A 27 A 28 C 29 A 30 C

Audioscript

Test One.

I am going to give you the instructions for this test. I shall introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you will hear this sound:

tone

You will hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you are listening, write your answers on the question paper. You will have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

PART 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Question 1

You hear a woman talking about learning to play the piano.

[pause]

tone

Woman: Learning to play the piano is far harder than I'd imagined when I started. You really can't improve unless you practise. I'm hopeless at that, but after all, I have a busy life, and this is just a hobby. However, it's one I enjoy, and the time I can spend doing it is precious. So while I admit I'm still playing very basic, easy pieces, and playing them pretty poorly at that, the little progress I have made encourages me to keep on going to lessons. My teacher's very patient, fortunately, and never makes me feel bad, so maybe I'll finally be able to impress my friends one day!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2

You hear a woman telling a friend about having a celebration dinner.

[pause]

tone

Man: Did you have a good weekend?

Woman: Yes, it was my sister's birthday and we cooked a meal for everyone. Cooking for other people can be so stressful. It had seemed a good idea to try a new recipe, and I'd got the ingredients ready in advance. I managed to forget ginger though, so the stir-fry was lacking a vital ingredient, but it didn't seem to matter. I always make way too much, so I had no concerns about people going hungry. Still, it was great that the conversation flowed so well, and in fact nobody seemed to want to leave. There was loads of clearing up though.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 3 *You hear a man telling a friend about a visit to a museum.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: Did you enjoy your visit to the museum last week?

Man: I did, thanks. You know how much I'd been looking forward to it – well, it lived up to all my expectations. As you know, they've just renovated the whole building, and it really is great. There's an exhibition on of paintings of the countryside around here. It made me realise I'd really like to do something like that too, so I've signed up for a beginner's painting course.

Woman: Great! And was the museum busy?

Man: Oh, yes – I've heard the place is permanently packed these days. I thought it would've been quiet on a Monday.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 4 *You hear two media students talking about a TV advert they have seen.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Did you see the advert for that new health drink?

Woman: I did, but I thought it was all pretty predictable ... you know, bright smiley faces ... young woman leaping about in slow motion ...

Man: Yes, there wasn't a great deal of novelty, was there? But then again, is there ever in an advert for a fruit drink? It was certainly technically very good, wasn't it?
Well-designed ...

Woman: Short and snappy ... made its point effectively. Not sure how believable the leaping woman was, though ... you know, the suggestion that if you drink it, you immediately come over all energetic.

Man: But surely you weren't meant to take that literally.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 5

You hear two people talking about a work colleague called Judy.

[pause]

tone

Man: Have you heard that Judy's leaving?

Woman: Yeah ... such a lovely person.

Man: I think she never really recovered from the disappointment of being overlooked for that promotion. Seemed to hit her hard, and she was the obvious person for the job, let's be honest.

Woman: In many ways she deserved it, sure. But Gavin, who got the job, was ... kind of more obviously committed, don't you think?

Man: Very energetic, yes. Judy was quieter, I guess ... she went about her daily business with no fuss. And what she did, she did very efficiently, so you could rely on her work being free of mistakes, which is very important in our line of business.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6

You hear two friends talking about a local project to start a community garden.

[pause]

tone

Woman: Are you coming to the meeting tomorrow? We're going to discuss the design of the community garden.

Man: No, community projects aren't my thing. Everyone starts off being really enthusiastic and then one by one they all drop out, and so all the work falls on a couple of people. I've seen it happen so many times. And where are the plants coming from?

Woman: All the plants, the land and equipment is being provided free of charge by the local council. The residents are really keen and we've elected a committee to run things too.

Man: Let's talk again in six months' time and see if it's still on track!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 1 answer key

Question 7

You hear two friends discussing watching films based on books.

[pause]

tone

Woman: Do you fancy going to see *Trapped* at the cinema tomorrow? I really enjoyed reading the book.

Man: I don't know how you can watch a film after you've read the book. I'd hate it if the film wasn't faithful to the storyline.

Woman: Yes, but once you're right into the film, you forget about that. It's only later that you think – oh hang on, that didn't happen in the book! I think you miss so much if you haven't read it. You don't know the inner thoughts of the characters or their motivation for doing things. It doesn't matter how good the director is, some things just can't be brought to the screen.

Man: Mmm.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 8

You hear a man telling a friend about a new sports centre.

[pause]

tone

Woman: So did you enjoy your visit to the new sports centre in town?

Man: Yes. I went for a swim and had a look round the gym.

Woman: Only a look round?

Man: Yes. I hadn't realised, but you have to become a member to use the gym.

Woman: But anyone can swim?

Man: Yes, or even use the athletics track. But they said the gym isn't open access ... they want everyone to have an induction programme to show them how to use the machines safely. With the track, there's an athletics club you can join if you want to get coaching and all that, but you don't have to ... that's the difference.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part One.

Now turn to Part Two.

[pause]

PART 2

You will hear a student called Petra Dean talking about her recent work experience as a volunteer in the Cloud Forest in Ecuador in South America. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

Hello, my name's Petra Dean and I'd like to tell you about my amazing trip to the Cloud Forest in Ecuador in South America. I volunteered there for a month last summer on the Cloud Forest Project.

I'm a postgraduate student now and my first degree was in Biology. While I was doing that, I realised that I wanted to continue my studies but specialise more – so I chose International Conservation, which I love doing. Going to Ecuador was a way for me to get in some practical experience.

When I arrived in Ecuador, I spent my first night in a hostel in the capital, Quito. The next day I set off for the nature reserve, which is situated in the Cloud Forest. The journey began with a three-hour bus ride out into the countryside. The second part was more unexpected. A donkey was the designated mode of transport up the steep forest paths to the reserve!

The reserve had its own farm, and at first I was assigned to work in the two gardens. The one which they called the Medicine Garden was where plants that can be used to treat illness were grown – it gave me a real buzz to know that I was growing plants for research that might heal people. The other was the organic vegetable garden where we grew our own delicious fruit and vegetables.

The weather was perfect for doing outside work. I was there during the rainy season, so the temperatures were very comfortable. There were storms each evening and they were really dramatic to watch. We were surrounded by the most amazing mountains, but for days on end they weren't visible due to the blanket of cloud that descended over the forest.

There were goats on the reserve, and one of my tasks was taking the milk down to the nearest village every day, which wasn't much fun. The barrels of fresh milk were loaded onto a bicycle and I had to steer it down the steep paths. It was exhausting because it seemed to have a mind of its own! When I got to the village, the milk was loaded into a rickety old lorry for the rest of the way down the mountain.

One aspect of the programme that I really appreciated was the forestry programme. Volunteers had to assist in collecting and planting seeds, maintaining the plant nursery and – my particular task – conducting forest inventories. That involved assessing the trees' growth. This provided invaluable information for scientists trying to learn about what's going on in the forest.

It wasn't all work though. We also had the chance to get to know the forest better. The local people taught us about the trees that are native to the area. We also had a mini-survival course and were instructed on the best way to put up shelters high up in the branches. Our guides showed us edible plants, but I found it impossible to identify them.

There was plenty of free time at the weekends. A friend and I spent one weekend cycling through the countryside, stopping off to explore the ruins of ancient villages. I'll never forget that! Over the next few weekends, we visited the nearby towns and saw the local sites of historical interest, which were surprisingly free of crowds as it was outside the tourist season.

The volunteer house had everything you could want – cold showers, electricity and comfortable bedrooms to unwind in after a long day of physical exertion. Then, after a delicious dinner of home-grown food served in the dining room, I wanted nothing more than to sit out on the terrace and listen to the sounds of the wildlife. That was just magical.

I can honestly say that I wouldn't change a thing about this experience. Oh, OK, maybe one thing ... I packed a mosquito net, insect spray and, of course, sun cream as suggested – but nowhere near enough. It was surprisingly hard to come by while I was there, and it was very expensive. But despite all that, I would say that it really was the trip of a lifetime!

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

[pause]

PART 3

You will hear five short extracts in which people talk about their jobs on a cruise ship. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) what each speaker says about working on a cruise ship. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

I work in the front office on board ship, answering passenger queries and so on. I used to work in the back office but I wanted to better myself, so I took some customer service evening courses at my local college between cruises and then re-applied for work on the ship. That's what's good about this line of work – you can move up quite quickly. What I love about this job is that you really get to interact with passengers. We get people from all walks of life – lots of couples, but families too. They come for the holiday of a lifetime – a bit of luxury – and why not?

[pause]

Speaker 2

There's a common misconception that everyone who works on a cruise ship is in their early twenties but most people here are older than me. I was going nowhere professionally, so thought I'd try my hand here. Most of the cruise singers – myself included – dream of being 'discovered' by a passenger who also happens to be a record producer – a bit unlikely I know! The staff quarters are brilliant – my cabin is better than my bedroom back home! And the social life is great too. We have some fantastic staff parties and we even put on our own concerts sometimes!

[pause]

Speaker 3

Well, I'm a bit of an oddity actually because I'm a whole lot older than most people who work onboard. I'm 68! Also, I don't get paid! That's right! Many people ask me why I do it, but I have the chance to go on all these wonderful cruises for absolutely nothing! My role is to accompany the groups when they go ashore and make sure everything runs smoothly. It's perfect! I spend all my time with the passengers, and I've made some lovely friends over the years. My husband does the same thing, but it's a shame it's on another ship, though. At least we have lots to talk about!

[pause]

Speaker 4

I'm a chef. Catering is hard work – it's really full on most of the time. Some nights I can't wait to get back to the cabin and put my feet up, even if the space is a bit small! My wife's a childminder onboard, and although we work completely different hours, it's ideal really 'cos otherwise I wouldn't see much of her. I qualified and worked in a restaurant in Canada, but I always wanted to travel. It's not a luxurious lifestyle for the staff onboard but the job does allow me to see new places.

[pause]

Speaker 5

[pause]

I work in the tour office organising the tours that the passengers can go on when we make our various stops. Although the pay isn't great – especially as we don't make any tips like they do in the restaurant – there are other perks. There are like loads of courses we can do. I've learnt Italian and brushed up my computer skills since I've been doing this job. The staff social activities are fantastic – almost as good as the passengers' entertainment! On the whole, the passengers are really nice. I mean, I love seeing them all dressed up in their posh clothes going in for dinner!

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

[pause]

PART 4

You will hear an interview with a man called Guy Riordan, who works as a stuntman performing dangerous scenes in movies. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part Four.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: When you see a fight or a car chase in a movie, it's often a stuntman or woman taking the risks – not a real actor! Guy Riordan's a top stuntman. Guy, do you usually work individually or in a team?

Guy: It depends ... in my first job I was part of a team of other stuntmen ... several of us had to jump off a fourth-floor rooftop together and get caught by the group on the ground. That involved relying on everyone else to do things properly, which wasn't something I enjoyed! Despite that uncertainty, I hoped my strength and sense of timing would get me through. Audiences rarely appreciate the lengths we go to to provide their entertainment!

Interviewer: Obviously it's dangerous, but what's the most challenging thing for you about the work?

Guy: It's a wonderful job, but like any career, you have to have tools – for a stuntman, it's his or her body – and if a stunt goes wrong, you can end up badly hurt. If I thought about that, though, I'd never do the job. But it's the never-ending process to up your game, to expand and extend what you're good at – that's the toughest bit. Of course, there's a lot of competition in the stunt world – that makes it exciting.

Interviewer: What was it like working on the movie *Raw Stuff*?

Guy: It's based on a true story about soldiers in action, so it was extremely important that the stunts didn't look like standard movie action sequences. The mountains we were filming in were stunning, which made up for having to hike up with 25 kilos of equipment on our backs ... you just didn't notice the weight! The view from the top was sensational. The tricky part was tumbling onto rocky mountain ledges so that the camera could be as close as possible, and the audiences would see and feel what those soldiers went through.

Interviewer: You've often acted as a stunt double for the actor Marty Walker ...

Guy: Yeah, Marty and I get on. He varies his size drastically from one movie to the next – he can go from athletic action hero to skinny professor in some major body transformations. His dedication to doing that's amazing. It affects me as well ... I had to put on weight for his last movie. Marty wanted to do the motorbike stunts himself, but we persuaded him not to. It involved jumping off at high speed ... pretty silly for an untrained person to try and do, or even a stuntman ...

Interviewer: Which movie do you remember filming most?

Guy: *Light at Dawn*. They wanted me to say some lines – real acting. After a few attempts I gave up and asked for someone else to do it. The director Peter Levene was very ambitious – some things he asked for hadn't been tried before. It was truly a pleasure when we got things right. We filmed all over the world – everyone on what was a huge film crew was completely exhausted flying from one place to the next!

Interviewer: How long have you been in the movie industry?

Guy: Twenty years. I've seen some changes. There's more technology these days, but there's just as great a need for stunt actors. Some things can only be performed by a real human. I've worked with some great people in some great locations – and had a lot of laughs – something that's increasingly missing these days because there's so much at stake. But that does mean the financial rewards for those who get into the big movies are generally worth it. I can't say I've been unlucky in that respect.

Interviewer: What would you advise someone wanting to do your job?

Guy: Stunt work's become highly specialised over the years. There's high falls, fight scenes, horse stunts, car chases, the list goes on. There's no easy answer to the question of whether it's better to become skilled at one thing or be diverse. I don't try and discourage people from getting into stunts, but I do try to convince them to have another source of income to fall back on. Most stuntmen I know also do things like construction, security, web design ... and though everyone has an agent to find them work, it's so often about your own contacts rather than anything else.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Four again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Four.

There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I shall remind you when there is one minute left, so that you are sure to finish in time.

[pause – four minutes]

You have one more minute left.

[pause – one minute]

That is the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.

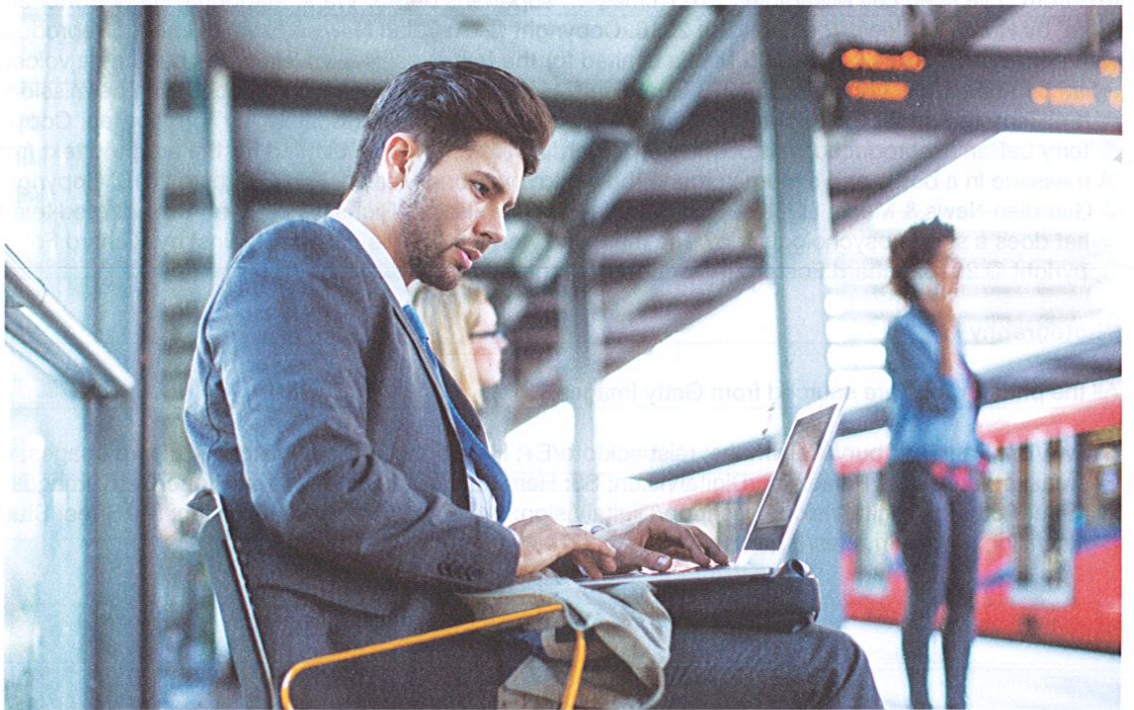
Visual materials for the Speaking test

Why are the people using laptops in these places?

1A



1B



Why are the people learning about the natural world in these places?

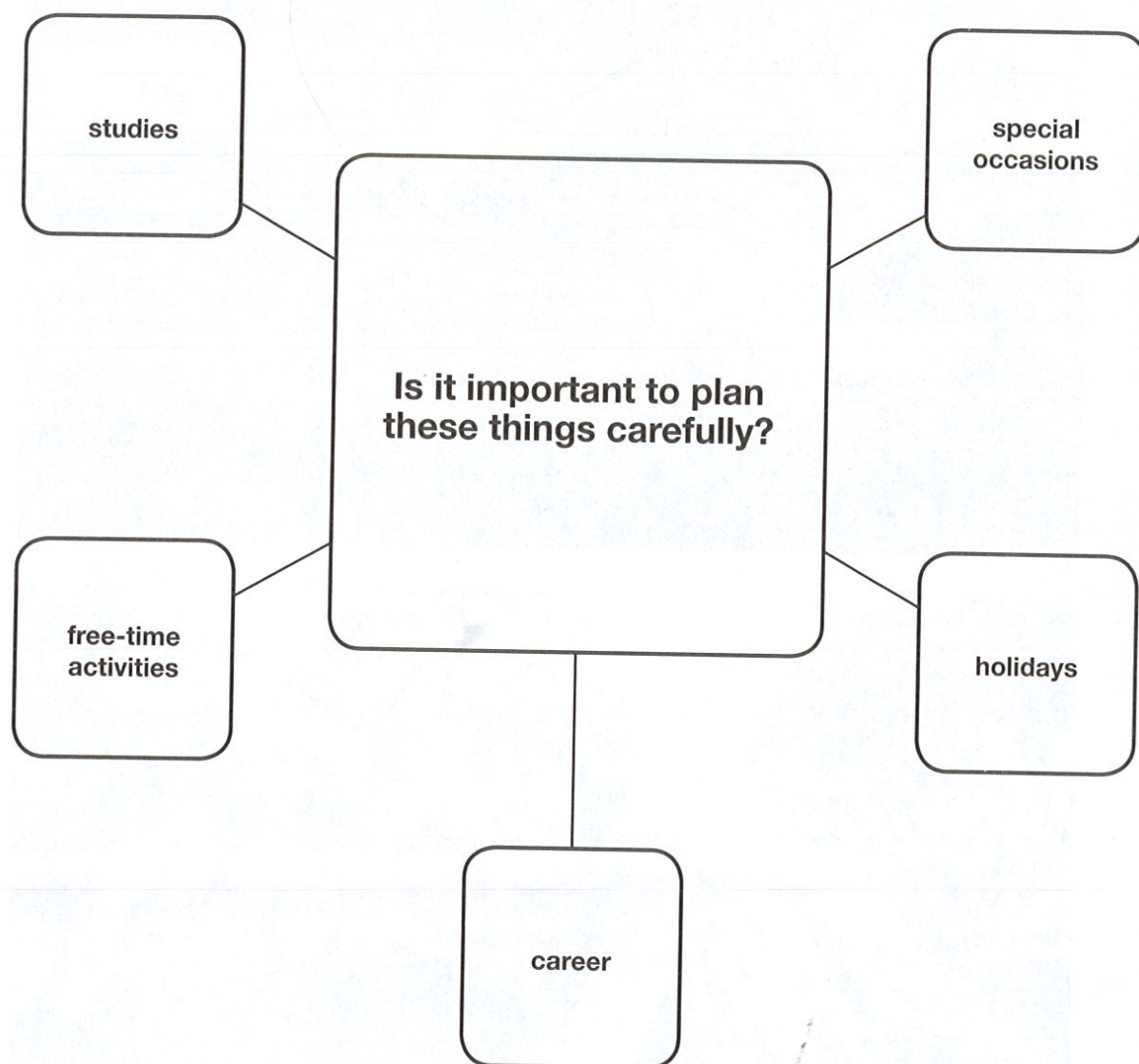
1C



1D



1E



What are the people enjoying about spending time in the forest?

2A



2B



Why do the people need help in these situations?

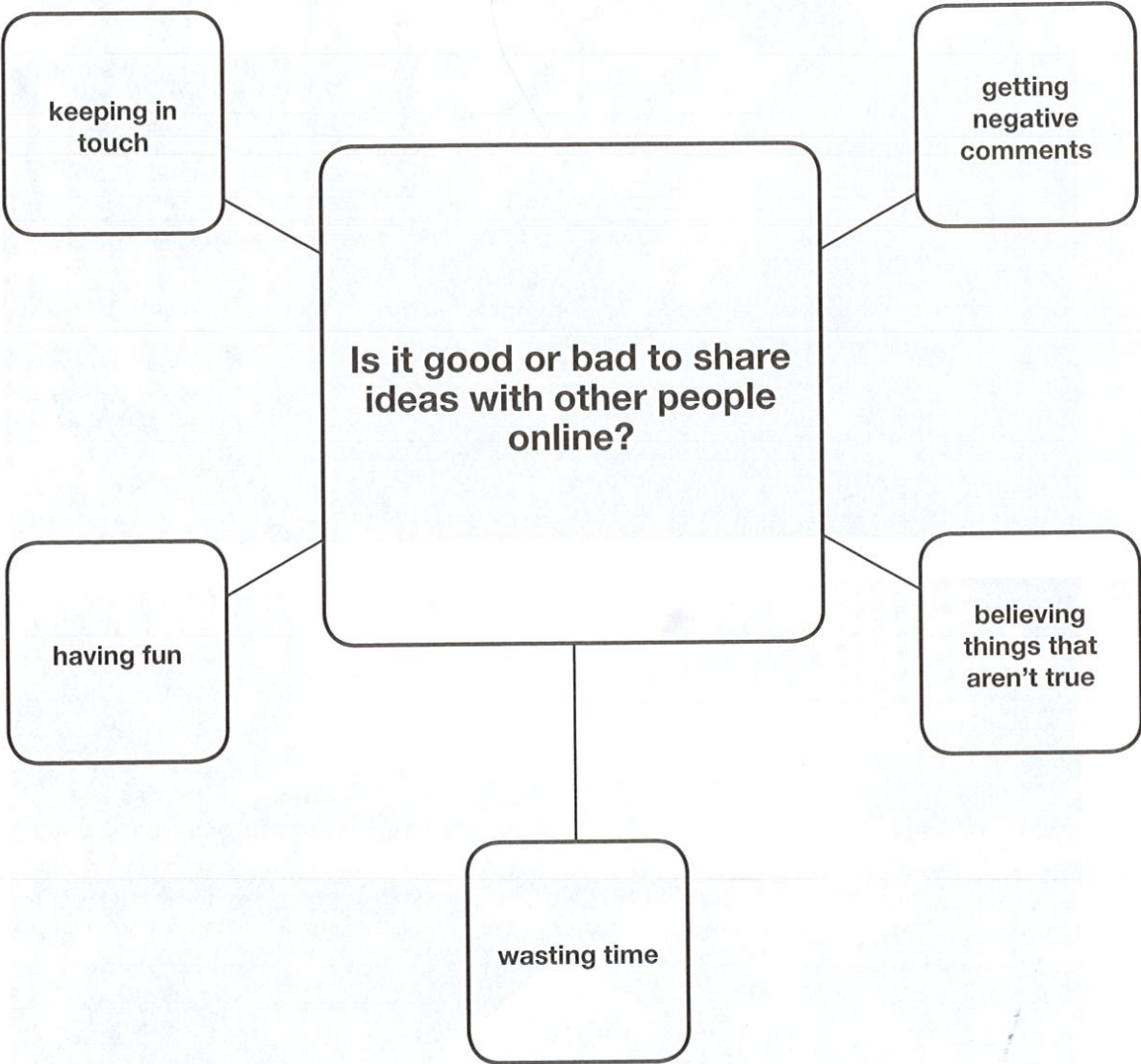
2C



2D

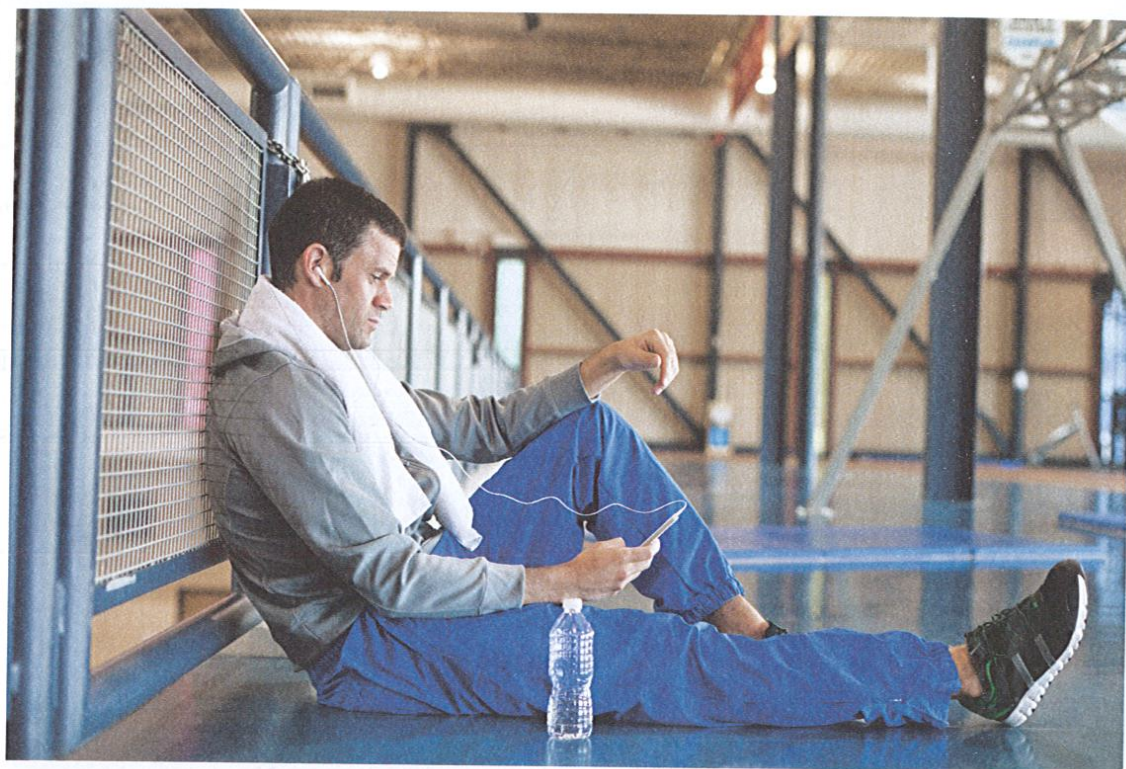


2E



Why are the people resting in these places?

3A



3B



What are the people enjoying about their music?

3C



3D

